SAMPLE TRAVEL ITINERARY • 21 DAYS / 20 NIGHTS

Philippines Three-Week Travel Itinerary

January 11 – January 31, 2027 • Dry-Season Highlands, Visayas & Palawan Island-Hopping Route

This three-week route links Luzon's historic capital and mountain rice terraces with the Central Visayas islands of Cebu and Bohol, surf-and-lagoon life in Siargao, and the limestone archipelagos of Palawan. January falls squarely in the cool dry season, offering calm seas for fast-craft ferries and island-hopping boats.

> **Inter-Island Route Overview:** Manila (2 nights) → Banaue & Sagada (3 nights) → Cebu & Moalboal (3 nights) → Bohol (2 nights) → Siargao (3 nights) → El Nido (3 nights) → Coron (3 nights) → Manila (1 night).

Week 1: Manila Heritage, Cordillera Highlands & Cebu Arrival (January 11 – January 17, 2027)

Day & Date	Island / Region	Daily Schedule
Day 1 Mon, Jan 11, 2027	**Arrival in Manila (Luzon)**	**Afternoon:** Arrive at Ninoy Aquino International Airport (MNL), pick up a local SIM/eSIM and PHP cash, and transfer to Makati or Bonifacio Global City (BGC) for check-in. **Evening:** Sunset walk along Ayala Triangle Gardens and introductory Filipino dinner (adobo, sinigang, and kare-kare).
Day 2 Tue, Jan 12, 2027	**Intramuros & Binondo (Manila)**	**Morning:** Guided walking or bamboo-bike tour of walled Intramuros, including Fort Santiago and San Agustin Church. **Afternoon:** Cross the Pasig River into Binondo (the world's oldest Chinatown) for a dumpling and lumpia street-food crawl, followed by the National Museum of Fine Arts. **Evening:** Board an overnight sleeper bus (e.g., Ohayami Trans) from Sampaloc, Manila north to Banaue (approx. 9 hours).
Day 3 Wed, Jan 13, 2027	**Banaue & Batad Rice Terraces**	**Morning:** Arrive in Banaue at dawn, check into a hillside guesthouse, and ride a local jeepney to the Batad Saddle. **Afternoon:** Trek down into the amphitheater-shaped Batad Rice Terraces (UNESCO World Heritage Site) and continue to Tappiya Falls. **Evening:** Return to Banaue town for a warm mountain dinner.
Day 4 Thu, Jan 14, 2027	**Banaue → Sagada**	**Morning:** Scenic mountain van transfer along the Halsema Highway corridor from Banaue to Sagada (approx. 2.5–3 hours). **Afternoon:** Walk Echo Valley to view the Hanging Coffins and explore Sumaguing Cave with an accredited local guide. **Evening:** Dinner at a pine-log cafe in Sagada town center.

Day & Date	Island / Region	Daily Schedule
Day 5 Fri, Jan 15, 2027	**Sagada → Baguio → Manila**	**Morning:** Sunrise viewpoint walk at Kiltepan Peak or Marlboro Hills above a sea of clouds. **Afternoon:** Morning bus via Baguio connecting southward back to Manila (approx. 10–11 hours total transit). **Evening:** Check into an airport-adjacent hotel in Pasay for an early domestic flight.
Day 6 Sat, Jan 16, 2027	**Manila → Cebu City → Moalboal**	**Morning:** Fly from Manila (MNL) to Mactan-Cebu International Airport (CEB, approx. 1 hour 20 minutes). **Afternoon:** Private van or South Bus Terminal transfer southwest across Cebu Island to Panagsama Beach, Moalboal (approx. 3 hours). **Evening:** Sunset snorkel right off the Panagsama house reef and beachfront seafood grill.
Day 7 Sun, Jan 17, 2027	**Badian Canyoneering & Moalboal**	**Morning:** Guided Matutinao River canyoneering adventure in Badian ending at turquoise Kawasan Falls. **Afternoon:** Snorkel with the massive Moalboal sardine run and sea turtles along the Panagsama drop-off. **Evening:** Relaxed beachside dinner in Moalboal.

Week 2: Cebu Heritage, Bohol Countryside & Siargao Island (January 18 – January 24, 2027)

Day & Date	Island / Region	Daily Schedule
Day 8 Mon, Jan 18, 2027	**Moalboal → Cebu City**	**Morning:** Morning transfer back to Cebu City. **Afternoon:** Visit Magellan's Cross, Basilica Minore del Santo Niño, Fort San Pedro, and Yap-Sandiego Ancestral House. **Evening:** Cebuano roast lechon dinner and city lookout views from Tops of Cebu on Mount Busay.
Day 9 Tue, Jan 19, 2027	**Cebu → Bohol (Panglao)**	**Morning:** Board an OceanJet fast-craft ferry from Cebu Pier 1 to Tagbilaran Port, Bohol (approx. 2 hours); transfer to Alona Beach, Panglao. **Afternoon:** Afternoon swim and snorkel along Dumaluan Beach's white sandbar. **Evening:** Dinner at Bohol Bee Farm overlooking the sea.
Day 10 Wed, Jan 20, 2027	**Bohol Interior & Balicasag**	**Morning:** Early boat trip to Balicasag Island Marine Sanctuary for reef wall snorkeling and Virgin Island sandbar. **Afternoon:** Countryside loop visiting the Chocolate Hills in Carmen, the Philippine Tarsier Sanctuary in Corella, and the Bilar Man-Made Forest. **Evening:** Sunset cruise along the Loboc River or dinner on Panglao.

Day & Date	Island / Region	Daily Schedule
Day 11 Thu, Jan 21, 2027	**Bohol → Cebu → Siargao**	**Morning:** Morning ferry back to Cebu Pier 1 and transfer to Mactan-Cebu Airport (CEB). **Afternoon:** Afternoon turboprop flight to Sayak Airport, Siargao (IAO, approx. 1 hour); transfer south to General Luna. **Evening:** Sunset walk along Cloud 9 boardwalk and dinner on Tourism Road.
Day 12 Fri, Jan 22, 2027	**Siargao Tri-Island Hopping**	**Morning:** Outrigger boat excursion to Naked Island sandbar and Daku Island. **Afternoon:** Fresh grilled seafood lunch under coconut palms on Daku Island, followed by snorkeling around Guyam Island. **Evening:** Casual dinner and live acoustic music in General Luna.
Day 13 Sat, Jan 23, 2027	**North Siargao & Sugba Lagoon**	**Morning:** Ride north through the Coconut Tree Viewdeck and Maasin River palm swing to Del Carmen. **Afternoon:** Paddleboard and kayak inside emerald Sugba Lagoon, then visit Magpupungko Rock Pools at low tide. **Evening:** Return to General Luna for dinner.
Day 14 Sun, Jan 24, 2027	**Siargao → Cebu → El Nido**	**Morning:** Fly from Siargao (IAO) via Cebu (CEB) directly into Lio Airport, El Nido, Palawan (ENI). **Afternoon:** Check into El Nido Town or Corong-Corong and unwind at Lio Beach. **Evening:** Sunset drinks at Las Cabañas Beach facing Bacuit Bay.

Week 3: Palawan Karst Lagoons — El Nido & Coron (January 25 – January 31, 2027)

Day & Date	Island / Region	Daily Schedule
Day 15 Mon, Jan 25, 2027	**El Nido Lagoon Tour A**	**Morning:** Full-day Bacuit Bay boat Tour A: kayak through the limestone walls of Big Lagoon and swim at Secret Lagoon. **Afternoon:** Beach picnic lunch on Shimizu Island and afternoon snorkeling at Seven Commandos Beach. **Evening:** Waterfront dinner in El Nido Town.
Day 16 Tue, Jan 26, 2027	**El Nido Beaches & Tour C**	**Morning:** Boat Tour C visiting Helicopter Island, Matinloc Shrine, and Hidden Beach. **Afternoon:** Late-afternoon tricycle ride north to wide, palm-lined Nacpan Beach. **Evening:** Return to Corong-Corong for dinner.
Day 17 Wed, Jan 27, 2027	**El Nido → Coron (Fast Ferry)**	**Morning:** Morning fast ferry from El Nido Port across the Linapacan Strait to Coron Town, Busuanga (approx. 3.5–4 hours). **Afternoon:** Hotel check-in and late-afternoon climb up the 700 steps of Mount Tapyas for panoramic views of Coron Bay. **Evening:** Soak in the saltwater Maquinit Hot Springs nestled in mangroves.

Day & Date	Island / Region	Daily Schedule
Day 18 Thu, Jan 28, 2027	**Coron Lakes & Lagoons**	**Morning:** Early boat departure to Kayangan Lake (crystal-clear freshwater lake ringed by karst cliffs) and Twin Lagoon. **Afternoon:** Snorkel the coral gardens of Siete Pecados Marine Park and lunch at Smith Beach. **Evening:** Dinner in Coron Town.
Day 19 Fri, Jan 29, 2027	**Coron Reefs & Shipwrecks**	**Morning:** Snorkel or dive the shallow Lusong Gunboat shipwreck and vibrant Lusong Coral Garden. **Afternoon:** Island-hop to Pass Island or Malcapuya Island for white-sand beaches and clear turquoise shallows. **Evening:** Sunset seafood dinner overlooking Coron Harbor.
Day 20 Sat, Jan 30, 2027	**Coron → Manila**	**Morning:** Free morning in Coron Town for cashew nut souvenirs and local market browsing. **Afternoon:** Fly from Busuanga Airport (USU) to Manila (MNL, approx. 1 hour 15 minutes) and check into hotel. **Evening:** Farewell dinner in Poblacion (Makati) or Bonifacio High Street (BGC).
Day 21 Sun, Jan 31, 2027	**Departure from Manila**	**Morning:** Pack dry bags and souvenirs, check out of hotel, and allow extra buffer time for Metro Manila traffic. **Afternoon:** Transfer to Ninoy Aquino International Airport (MNL) for international departure flight.

Practical Travel Notes

- **Inter-Island Flights & Ferries:** Book domestic flights (Philippine Airlines, Cebu Pacific, and AirSWIFT for direct El Nido routes) 6–8 weeks in advance, noting that turboprop flights to Siargao and Coron often enforce a strict 10–20 kg checked baggage limit.
- **Cash & Connectivity:** Carry sufficient Philippine Pesos (PHP) in smaller bills before traveling to Banaue, Sagada, Siargao, and El Nido, as ATMs in island towns can occasionally run out of cash or reject foreign cards.
- **Buffer Days & Marine Gear:** Building Day 20 in Manila protects international connections against weather-related turboprop delays. Pack reef-safe sunscreen, water shoes, and a 10–20L waterproof dry bag for boat landings.